claimed). There was nevertheless concern that U-2 overflights would identify the missiles. Fursenko and Naftali recount that the chief Soviet military representative in Cuba, Major-General A.A. Dementyev, told Marshal Malinovsky that 'It will be impossible to hide these missiles from American U-2s', whereupon the Soviet Minister of Defence kicked the general under the table.[65] Khrushchev himself understood the problem of the U-2s and decided in early July to prioritise deployment of surface-to-air missiles that could shoot down the spy planes. Such action would have precipitated an immediate crisis and almost certainly triggered a US military response. Here, as in other decisions, Khrushchev seems not to have thought through the implication of his actions, and how his political and military objectives were to be aligned.

Operation Anadyr was an extraordinary logistical feat, especially given that the USSR had no history of large-scale naval operations. It also illuminated Soviet approaches to deception (or *maskirovka).* Elaborate security measures were taken to ensure ballistic missiles and their equipment were transported across the Soviet Union to their half-dozen embarkation ports. Eighty-five freighters made 150 trips. These included ships with sufficiently large holds to carry the R-12 MRBMs (NATO designation SS-4 Sandal) and R-14 IRBMs (NATO designation SS-5 Skean). Soviet personnel were provided with winter uniforms and fur hats and led to believe they were headed for the Arctic. Captains of ships and submarines only learned their destination when they opened their sealed orders far out to sea.

Nuclear-armed tourists

For many of the Soviet troops, the weeks spent in transit were gruelling.[66] The men were kept below deck in sweltering temperatures and overcrowded conditions. When they arrived in Cuba, they were provided with tropical clothes and kept apart from the Cuban population. Those fortunate enough to travel on a requisitioned passenger liner appeared on deck in the guise of tourists as they approached Cuban ports. On arrival, they were cautioned to display 'Soviet socialist ideology' and not to visit